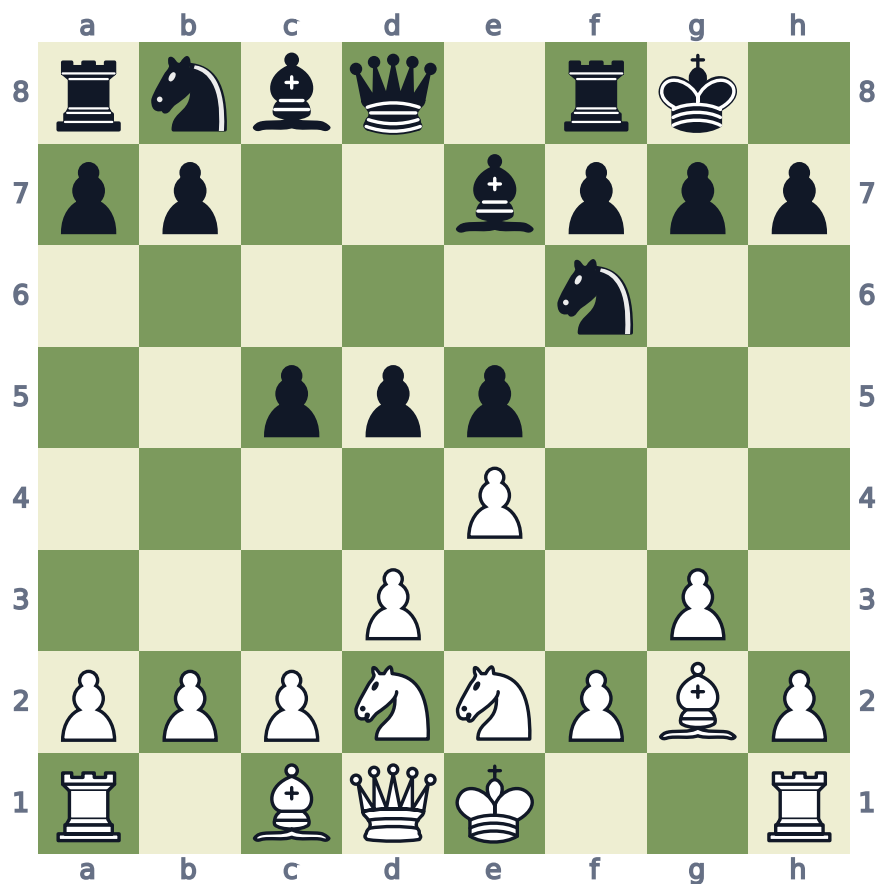


White Hippo Pawn-Structure and Plan Atlas

Thirty structures, breaks, files, outposts, and piece-placement rules



Connect the setup to the recurring middlegames so unfamiliar move orders can be solved from pawn structure rather than memory.

30 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Connect the setup to the recurring middlegames so unfamiliar move orders can be solved from pawn structure rather than memory.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 30 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The center determines which Hippo pieces are good or bad.

PRINCIPLE 2

Every break opens lines and abandons squares.

PRINCIPLE 3

Closed centers require a second break and a clear maneuvering route.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Long diagonals matter only when their paths and targets are real.

PRINCIPLE 5

The least active piece often reveals the next preparatory move.

PRINCIPLE 6

Structure knowledge is the durable part of an opening repertoire.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRUCTURE CHECKLIST

Read the pawns before choosing a plan

1. CENTER

Is it open, closed, fixed, mobile, or under immediate tension?

2. PAWN BREAKS

Which pawn move can change the structure, and what squares will it abandon?

3. FILES

Which files will open after the likely exchanges?

4. OUTPOSTS

Which squares cannot be challenged by an enemy pawn?

5. BAD PIECE

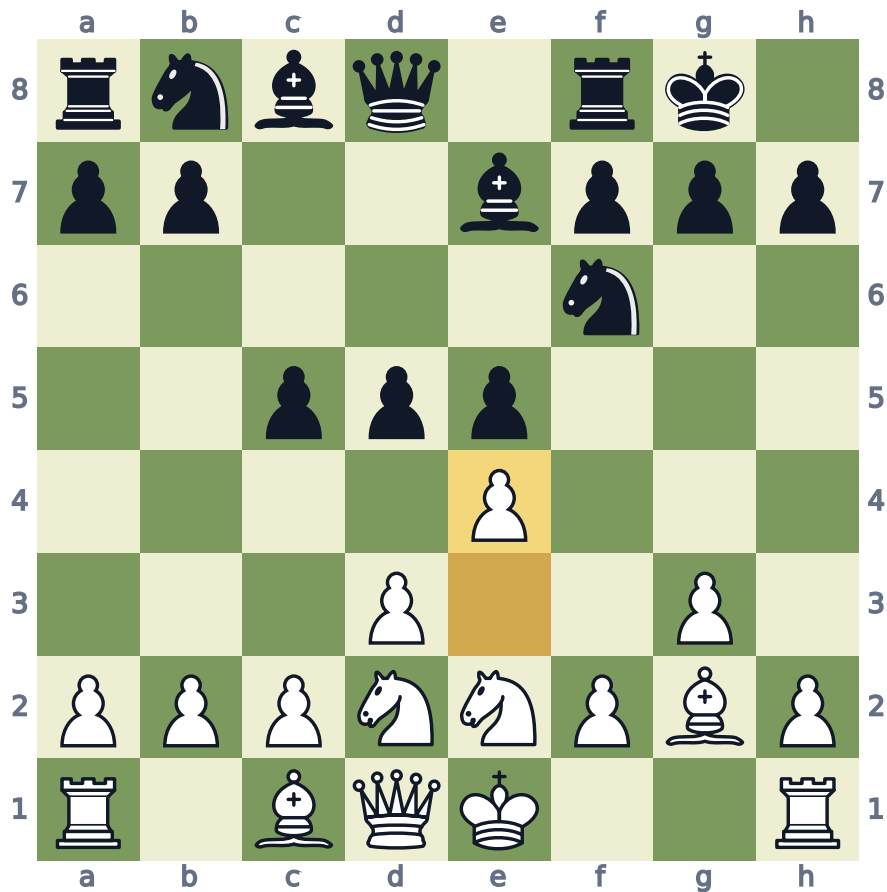
Which piece has the fewest useful squares, and what pawn move would improve it?

6. WING

Which side of the board does the pawn chain point toward?

STRUCTURE 01 OF 30

e4 against the full center



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 and create central contact before Black advances.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can close the center and begin a queenside space grab.

ENGINE SAMPLE

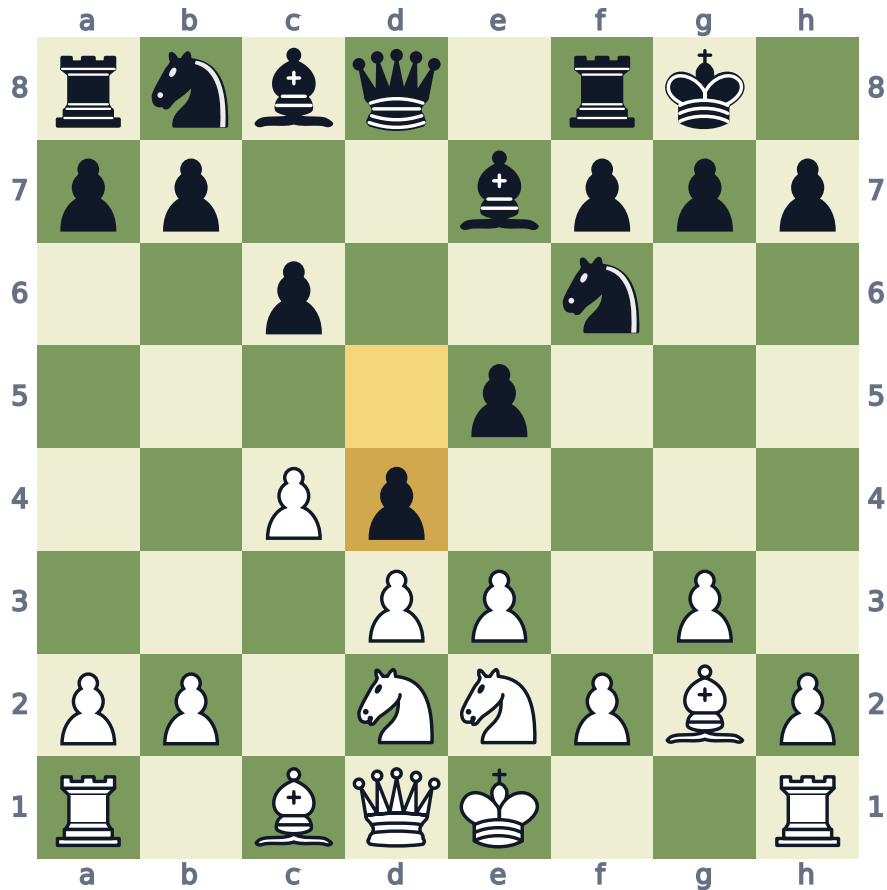
1. Nc6 O-O 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 Bb2 (-0.84 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Play e4 before the broad center becomes a fixed wall.

STRUCTURE 02 OF 30

c4 against the full center



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and use the c-file after exchanges.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black's d4 creates space and may restrict Nd2.

ENGINE SAMPLE

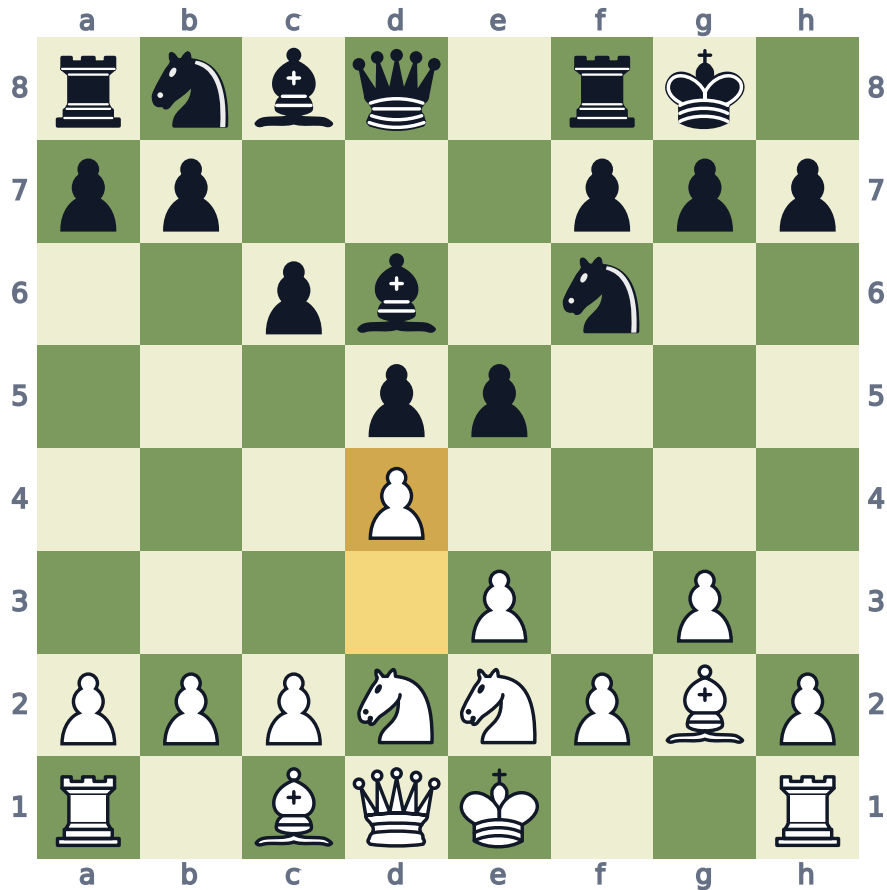
1. exd4 exd4 2. O-O h6 3. Re1 Re8 4. Nf4 a5 (-0.09 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

After c4-d4, name the second break before maneuvering.

STRUCTURE 03 OF 30

d4 against e5



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge e5 directly and invite a clarified center.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e4 can close the center and limit the g2 bishop.

ENGINE SAMPLE

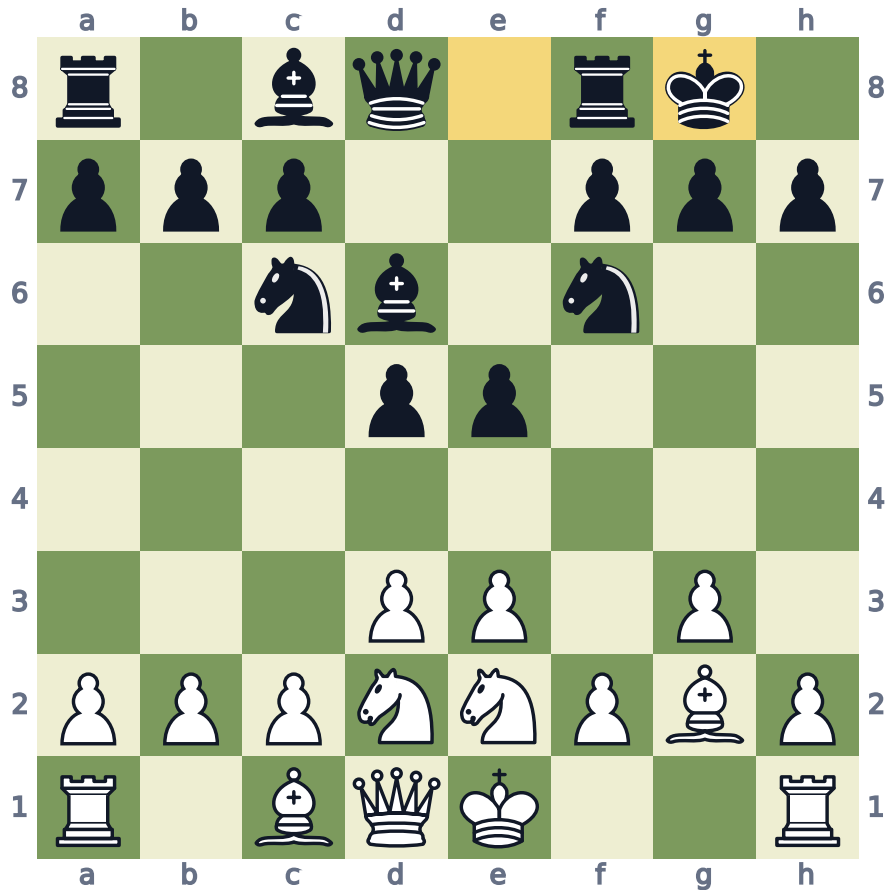
1. e4 c4 2. b5 cxb5 3. cxb5 O-O 4. b4 f3 5. exf3 Nxf3
(-1.07 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

d4 is a transformation into an open or closed central game.

STRUCTURE 04 OF 30

Single e5 with d4 challenge



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Prepare d4 and develop rapidly against a single central pawn.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e4 can gain space if White delays.

ENGINE SAMPLE

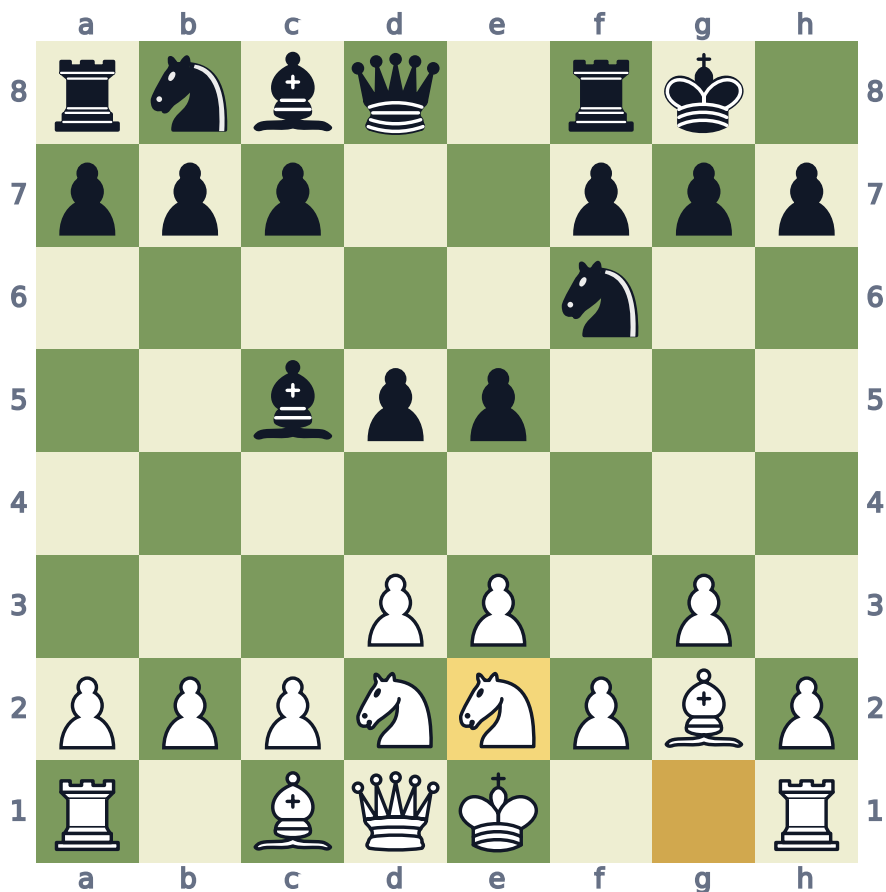
1. O-O Ne7 2. c4 c6 3. e4 h6 4. exd5 cxd5 5. d4 exd4 (-0.50 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

The less support e5 has, the more attractive d4 becomes.

STRUCTURE 05 OF 30

Black develops Bc5



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Prepare d4 without exposing the king to a central tactic.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Ng4 and d4 can create pressure before White castles.

ENGINE SAMPLE

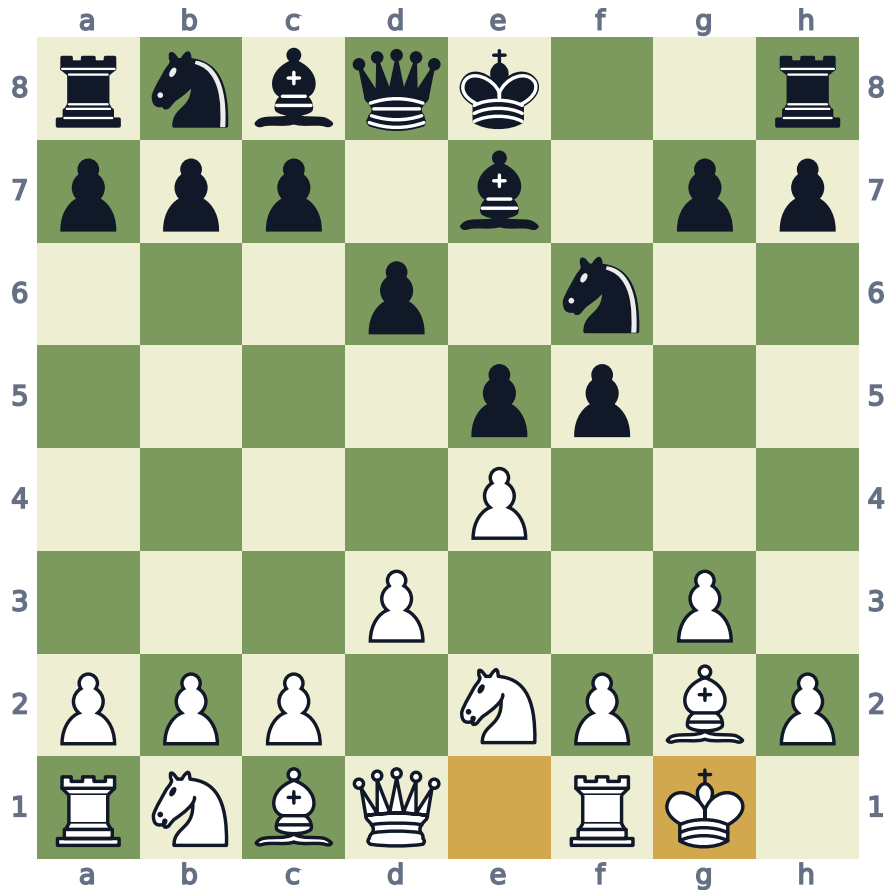
1. Re8 a3 2. a5 b3 3. Bf5 (-0.61 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Open-center systems reward king safety before flank moves.

STRUCTURE 06 OF 30

Early f5 with e4 restraint



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use e4 to block the f-pawn's support and prepare f4 or exf5.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

fxe4 can open the f-file and central diagonals.

ENGINE SAMPLE

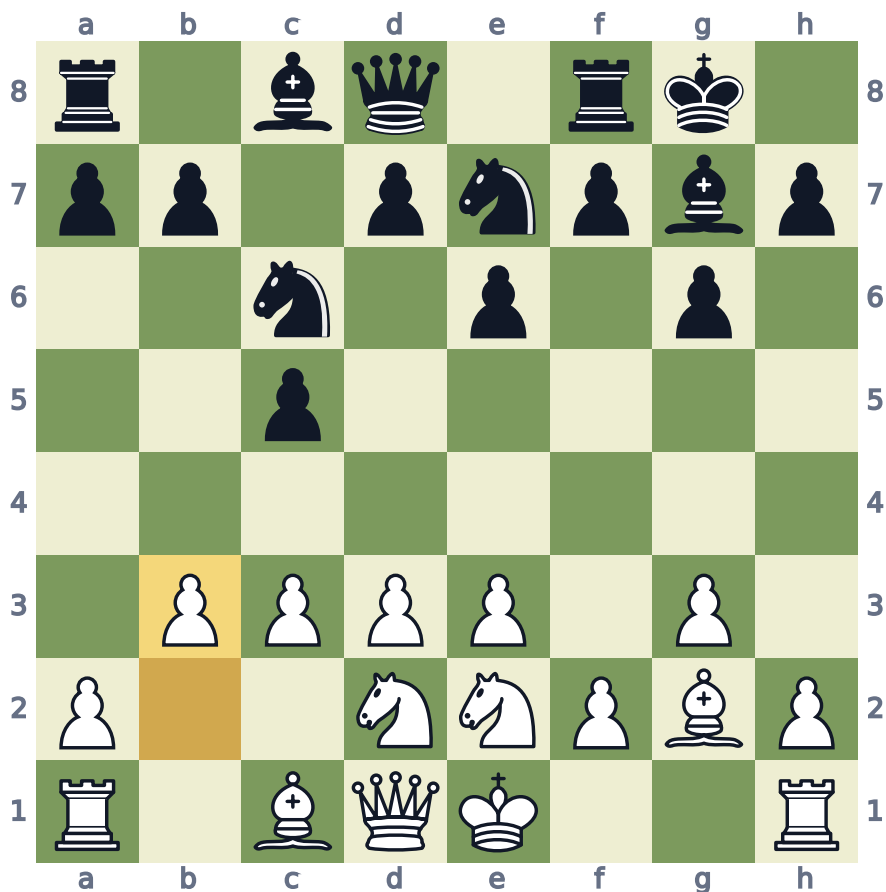
1. fxe4 dxe4 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 c4 (+0.00 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Against f5, stop the pawn chain from rolling before adding b3.

STRUCTURE 07 OF 30

Sicilian fianchetto core



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use c3 to secure a1 and prepare d4 or e4.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d5 can equalize before White claims the center.

ENGINE SAMPLE

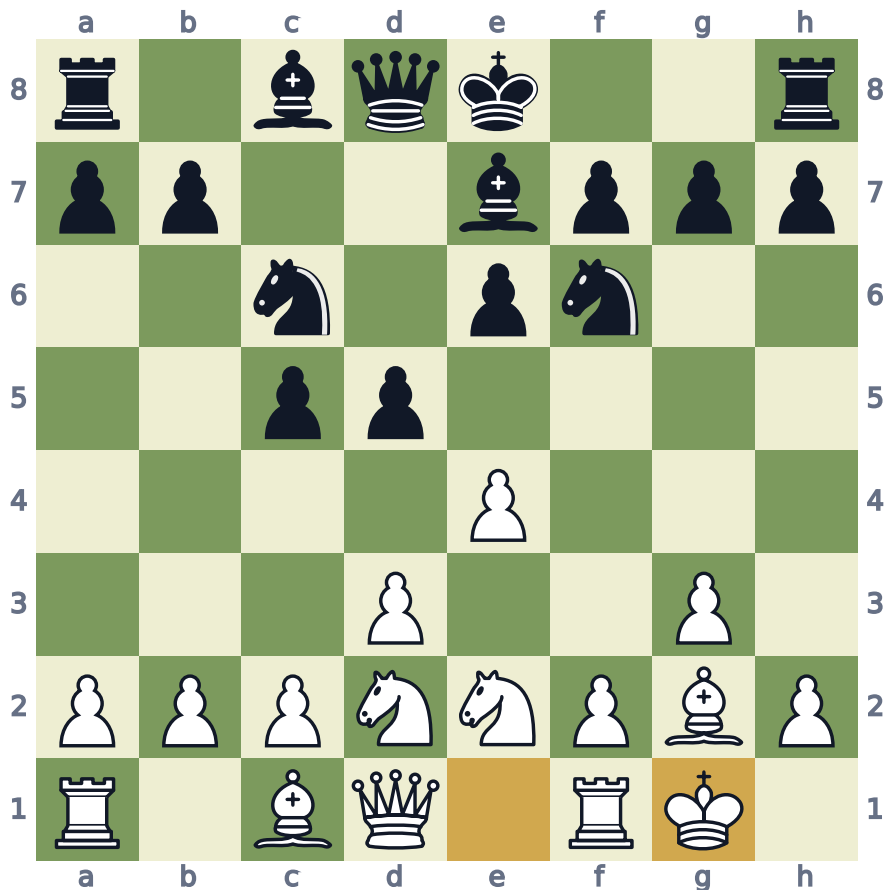
1. d5 O-O 2. b5 Bb2 3. Qb6 Qc2 4. Rd8 a3 5. e5 (-0.46 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Close the long diagonal before b3.

STRUCTURE 08 OF 30

Sicilian with e6 and d5



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Build a Closed Sicilian center and prepare f4 or c3.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can close space and restrict both knights.

ENGINE SAMPLE

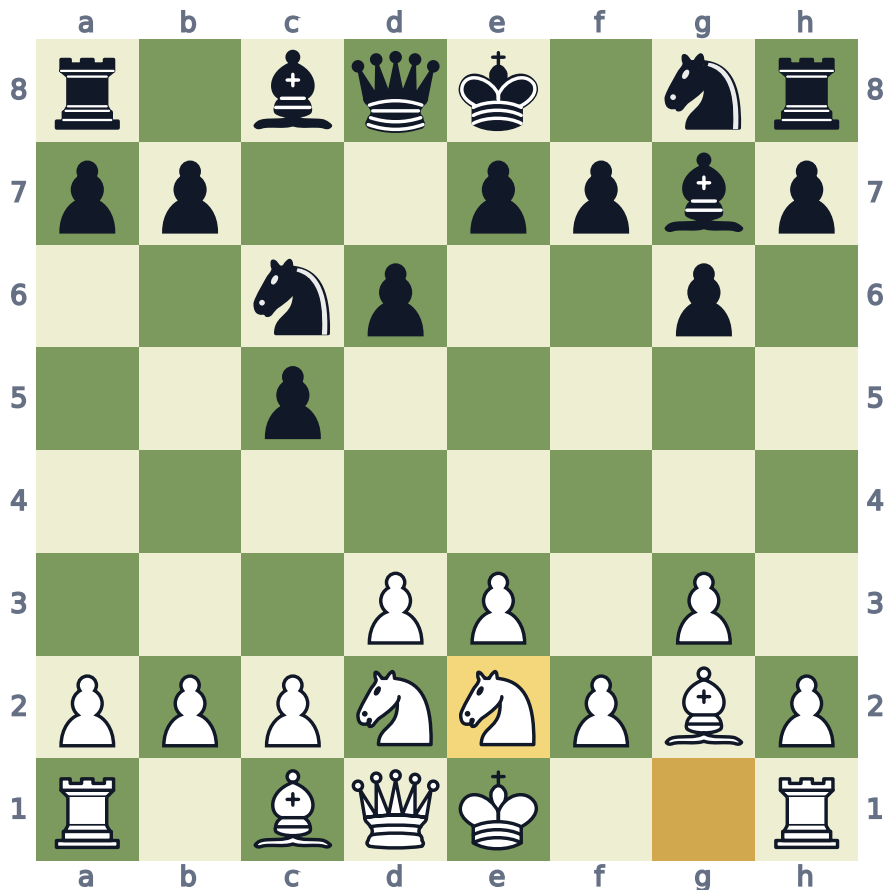
1. O-O Re1 2. e5 exd5 3. Nxd5 Nc3 4. Be6 Nc4 5. f6 f4 (-0.14 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Against e6-d5, e4 fixes a target and keeps f4 available.

STRUCTURE 09 OF 30

Sicilian with d6 and g6



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Keep the center flexible and prepare e4 or c3-d4.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black may play e5 or h5 before White acts.

ENGINE SAMPLE

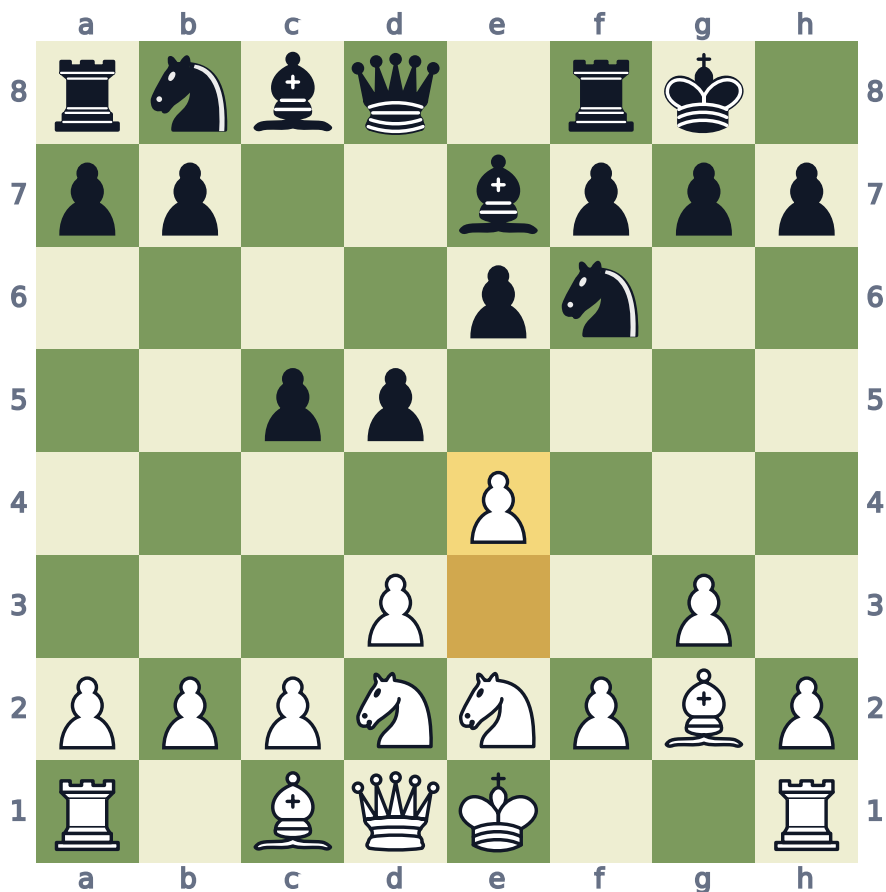
1. Nf6 O-O 2. O-O c4 3. d5 d4 4. cxd4 cxd5 5. Nxd5 Nxd4 (-0.42 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

A slow Sicilian setup gives choice, not unlimited time.

STRUCTURE 10 OF 30

French shell with e4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 and transpose toward a King's Indian Attack structure.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can gain space and close the g2 bishop.

ENGINE SAMPLE

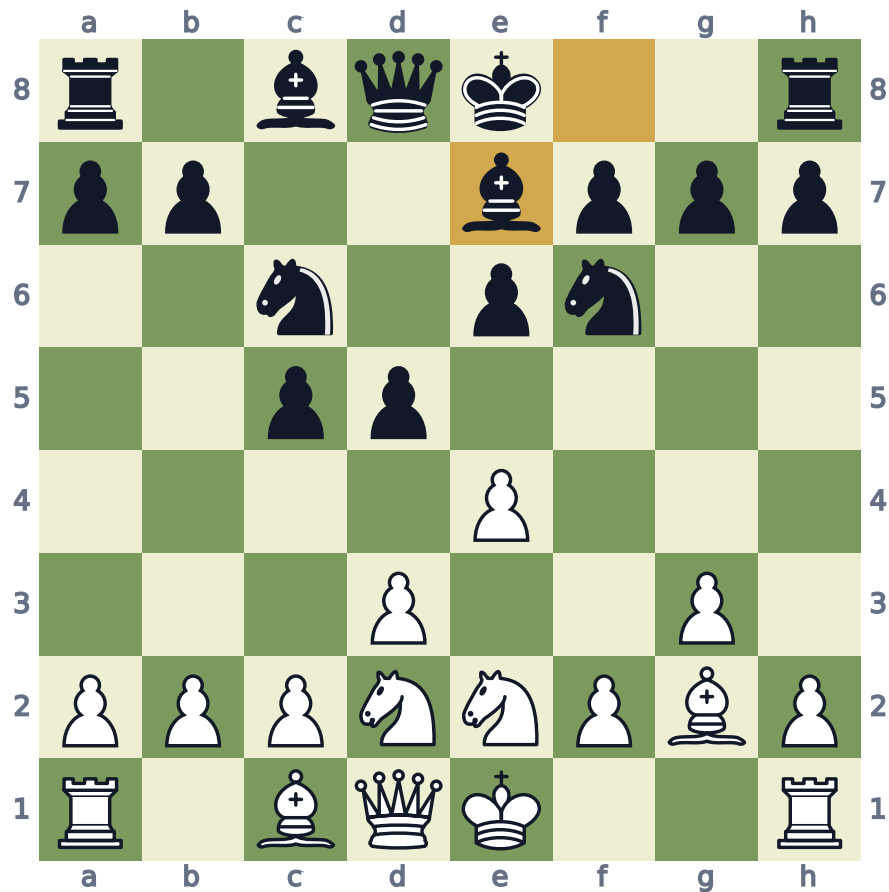
1. Nc6 exd5 2. exd5 O-O 3. Re8 Nf4 4. Bf8 Nf3 5. h6 h3
(-0.52 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against e6-d5, e4 is useful before Black fixes the chain.

STRUCTURE 11 OF 30

French shell with c4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use e4 and c4 pressure to prevent a free classical center.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can create a Benoni-like space bind.

ENGINE SAMPLE

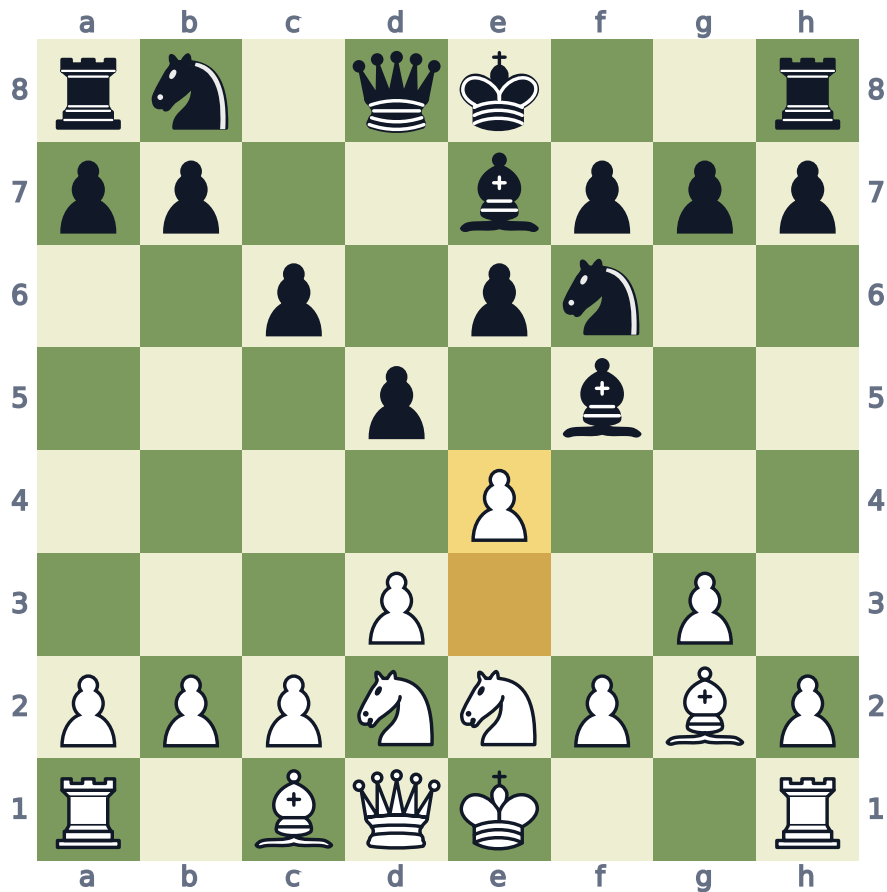
1. O-O e5 2. exd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nc4 O-O 5. Re1
(-0.15 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Challenge d5 with a flank pawn only when the center remains supported.

STRUCTURE 12 OF 30

Caro shell with e4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 after Black's bishop leaves the pawn chain.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

dx e4 can open lines while White is uncastled.

ENGINE SAMPLE

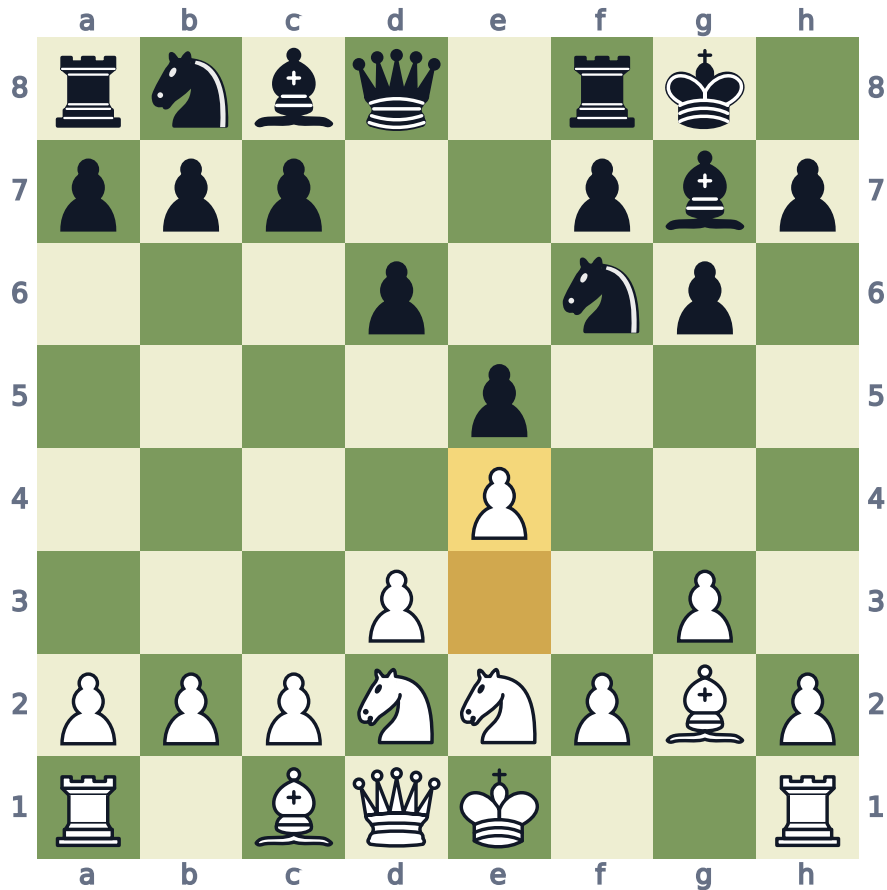
1. Bg6 Nf4 2. e5 Nxg6 3. hxg6 Qe2 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Prepare e4 with pieces, then calculate the exchange.

STRUCTURE 13 OF 30

Mirrored fianchetto with e4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use the extra tempo to claim e4 and prepare f4 or d4.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

f5 can create a fast kingside attack.

ENGINE SAMPLE

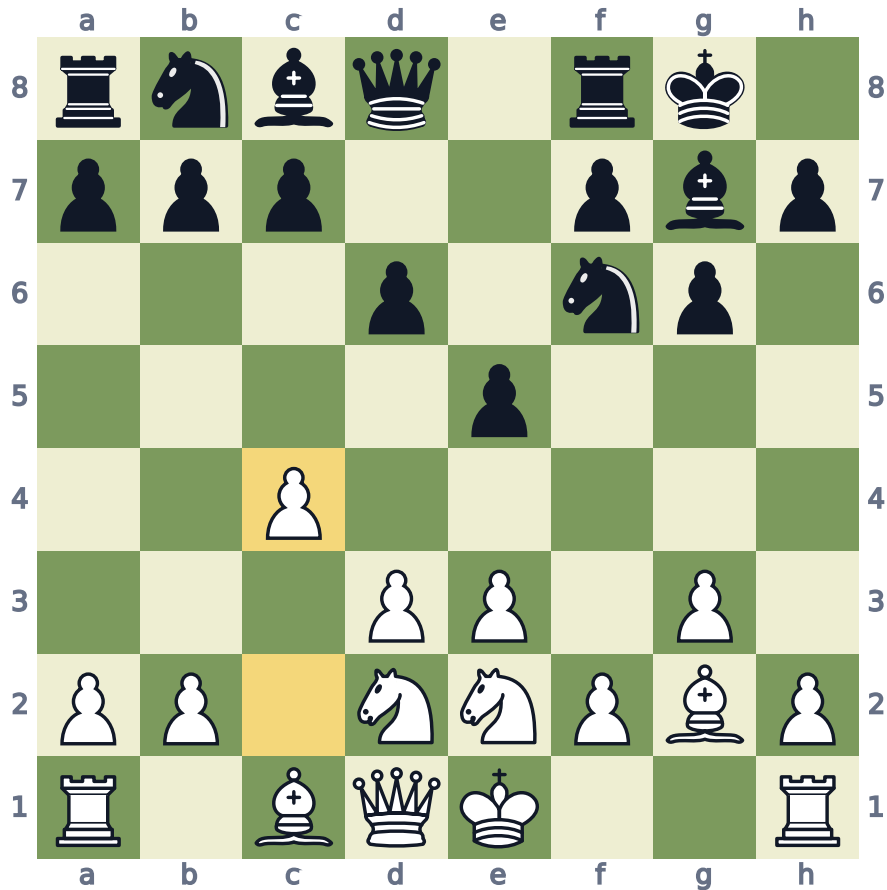
1. a5 O-O 2. Nc6 b3 3. Be6 c4 4. Nd7 Nf3 5. Bg4 Bg5
(-0.48 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Break symmetry with a center claim, not a random pawn move.

STRUCTURE 14 OF 30

Mirrored fianchetto with c4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Control d5 and prepare a Botvinnik or English structure.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

c6 and d5 can challenge the queenside bind.

ENGINE SAMPLE

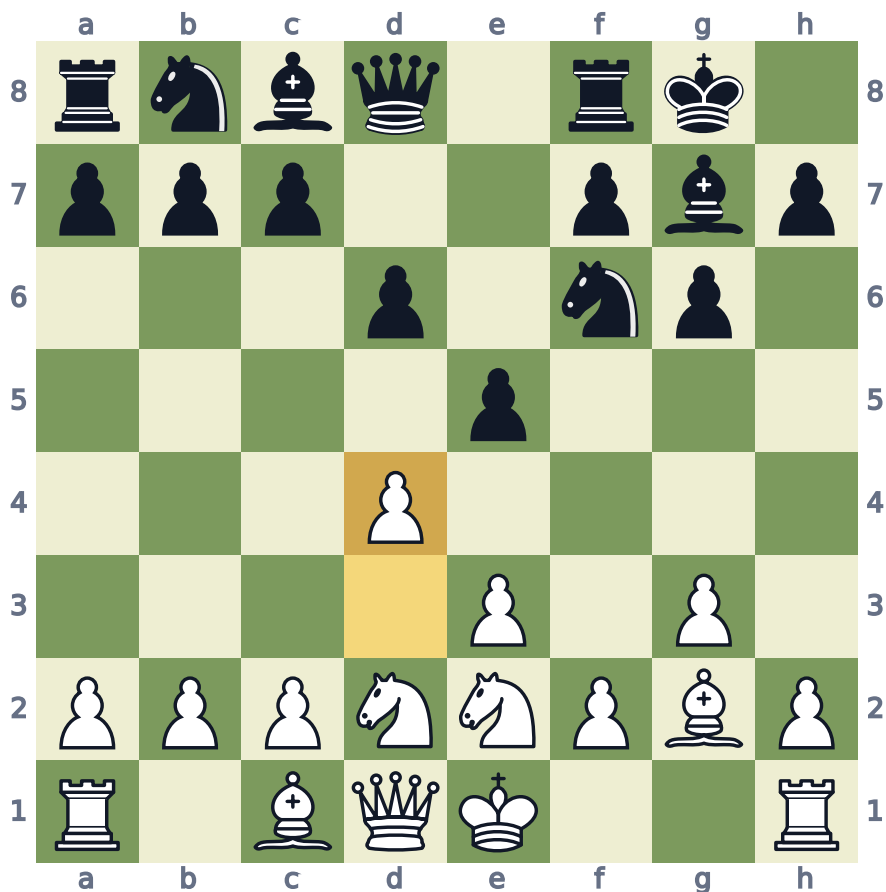
1. a5 b3 2. c6 O-O 3. Na6 Ba3 4. Nb4 Ne4 5. Nxe4 dxe4 (-0.31 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

c4 is useful when d5 is the strategic square.

STRUCTURE 15 OF 30

Mirrored fianchetto with d4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge e5 and clarify the center before Black starts f5.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e4 can close the center and gain kingside space.

ENGINE SAMPLE

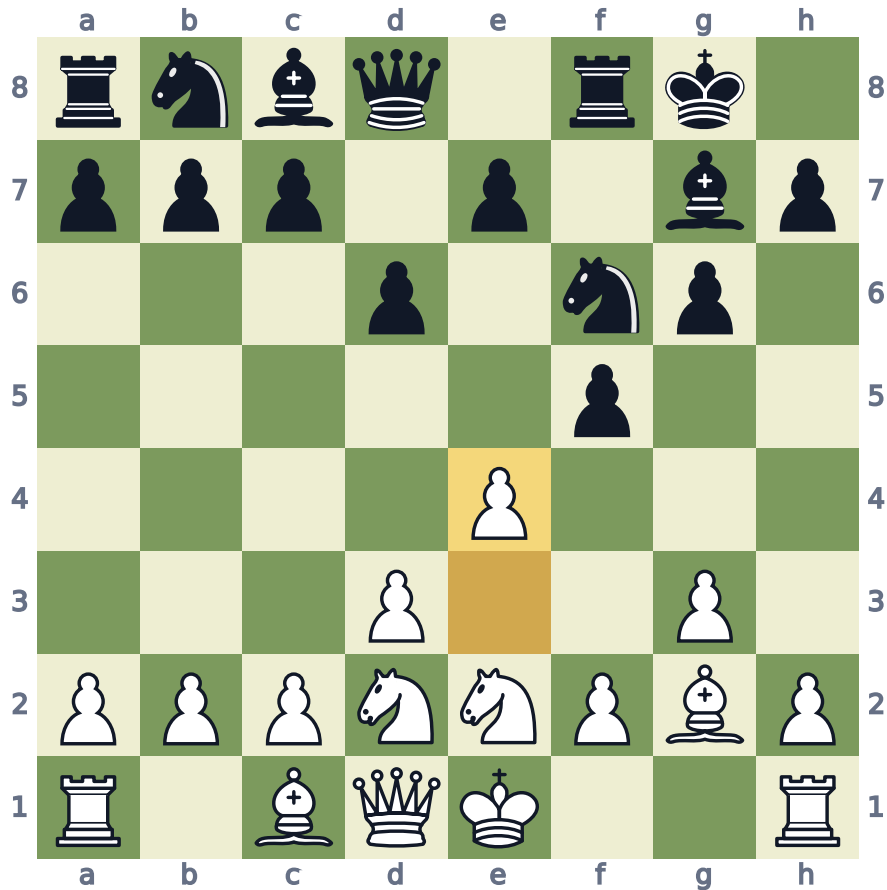
1. a5 b3 2. a4 O-O 3. exd4 exd4 4. Re8 Re1 5. axb3 cxb3 (-0.61 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

d4 asks the e5 pawn to define the game.

STRUCTURE 16 OF 30

Leningrad Dutch structure



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Occupy e4 and prepare f4 or a central exchange against Black's f-pawn.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e5 and a kingside attack can arrive rapidly.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Nc6 O-O 2. e5 Nc4 3. fxe4 dxe4 4. Be6 Ne3 5. Qd7 Nc3 (-0.30 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Against the Leningrad, e4 is the central prize.

STRUCTURE 17 OF 30

Classical Dutch center



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Open the center while Black's king and e6 pawn remain potential targets.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can close the center and support a kingside attack.

ENGINE SAMPLE

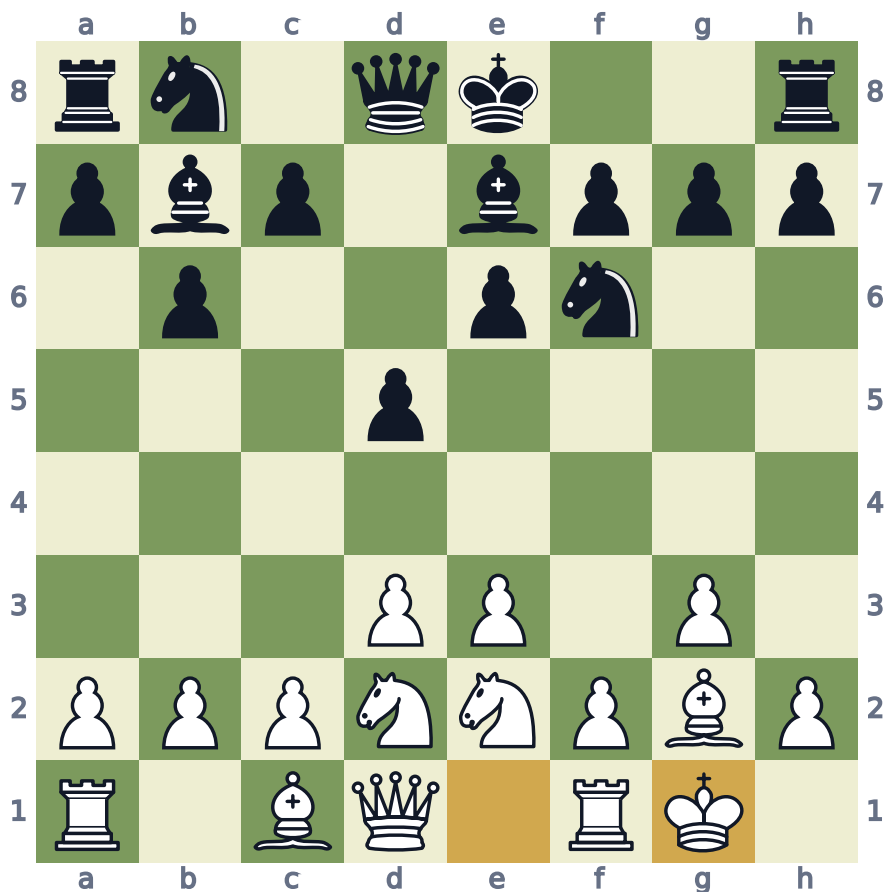
1. Nc6 c3 2. dxe4 Qe2 3. Qd3 Nxe4 4. Qxe2+ Nxe2 5. e5 O-O (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Use e4 before Black completes a Stonewall shell.

STRUCTURE 18 OF 30

Owen queenside fianchetto



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use d5 to block the long diagonal and prepare e4 or c4.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

c5 may attack the center before White is ready.

ENGINE SAMPLE

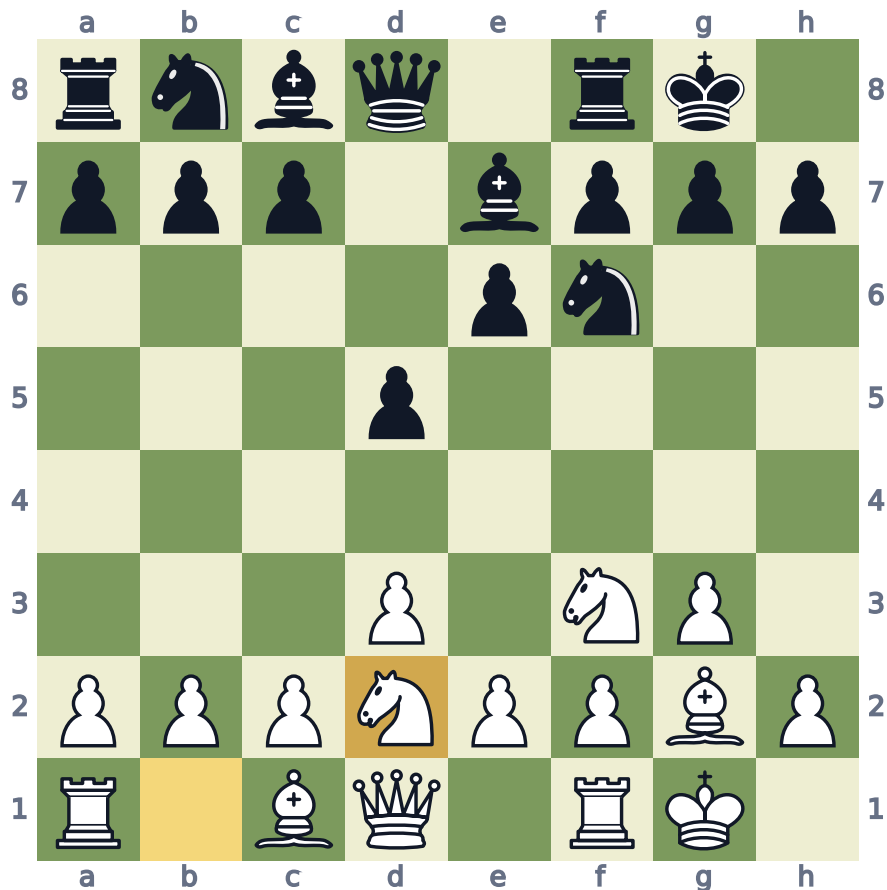
1. O-O b3 2. c5 Bb2 3. Nc6 d4 4. Qc7 Nf4 5. cxd4 exd4 (-0.25 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

A queenside fianchetto is met by the center, not by chasing the bishop.

STRUCTURE 19 OF 30

Nf3-first move order



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use Nf3 to restrain e5, then enter a White-Hippo shell with faster castling.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

The knight blocks f4 and changes some attacking plans.

ENGINE SAMPLE

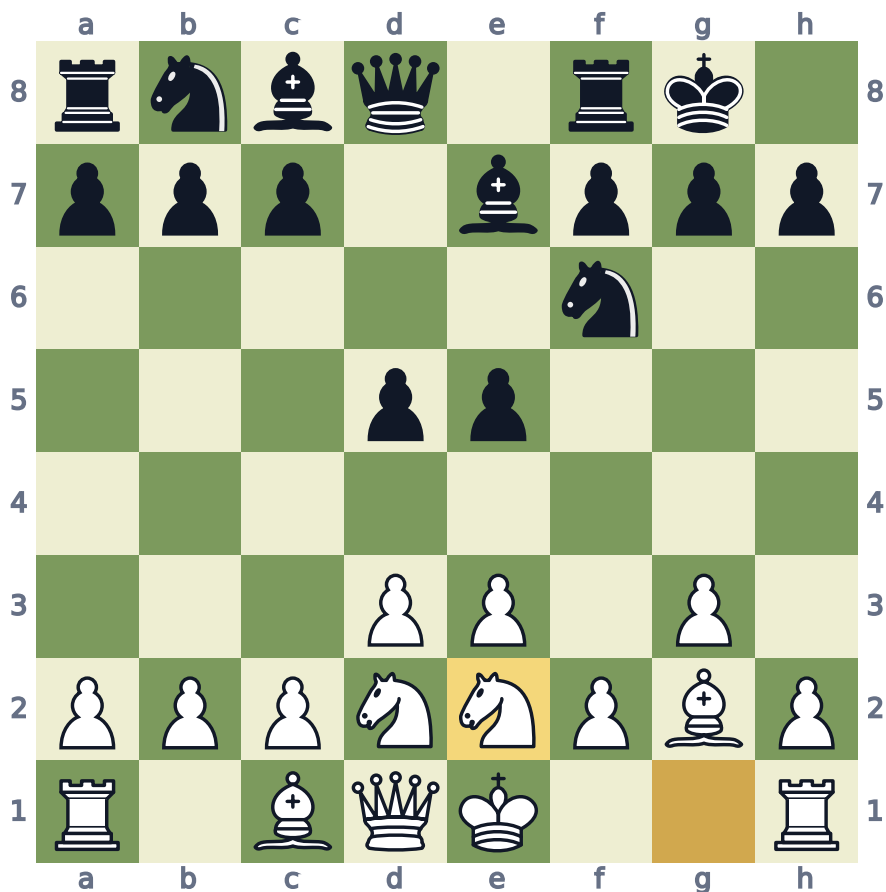
1. c5 Re1 2. Nc6 e4 3. Qc7 c3 4. dxe4 dxe4 5. e5 Nc4 (+0.04 for White (equal))

TRANSFER CUE

Nf3 buys e5 control at the price of f-pawn freedom.

STRUCTURE 20 OF 30

e3-first move order



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use e3 to support d4 and free the queen bishop before fianchettoing.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e4 can gain space before White completes development.

ENGINE SAMPLE

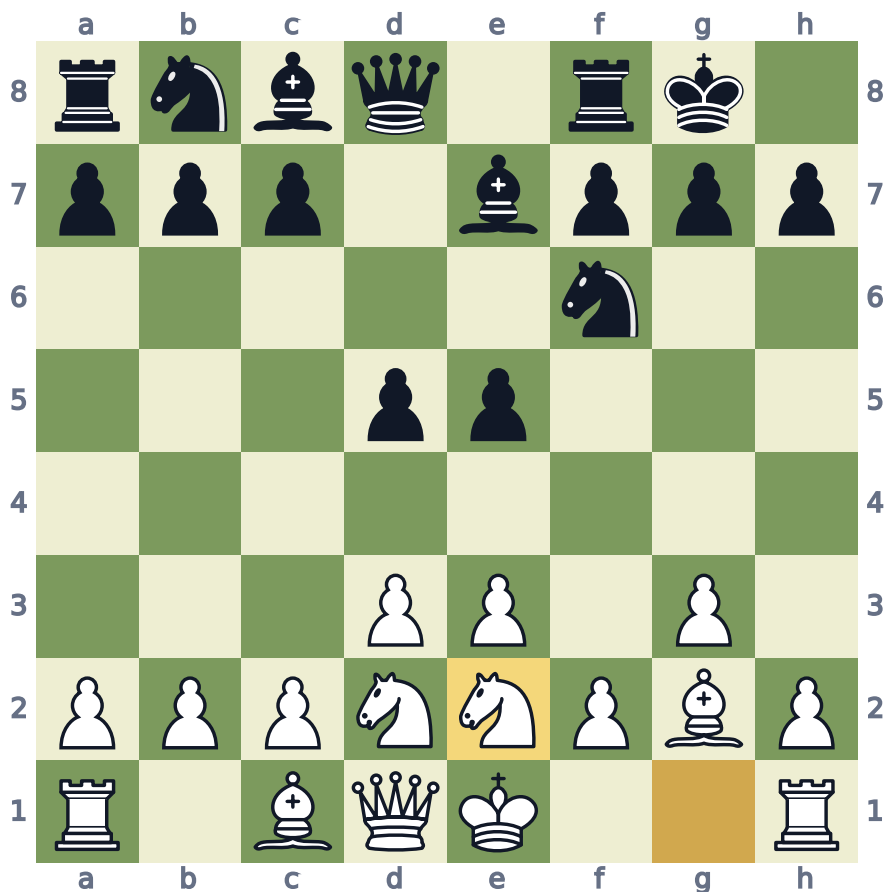
1. c5 O-O 2. Nc6 d4 3. exd4 exd4 4. Re8 dxc5 5. Bxc5 (-0.64 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

e3-first points toward d4 more strongly than f4.

STRUCTURE 21 OF 30

d3-first move order



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Support e4 immediately while preserving both knight choices.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

Black can use f5 before White castles.

ENGINE SAMPLE

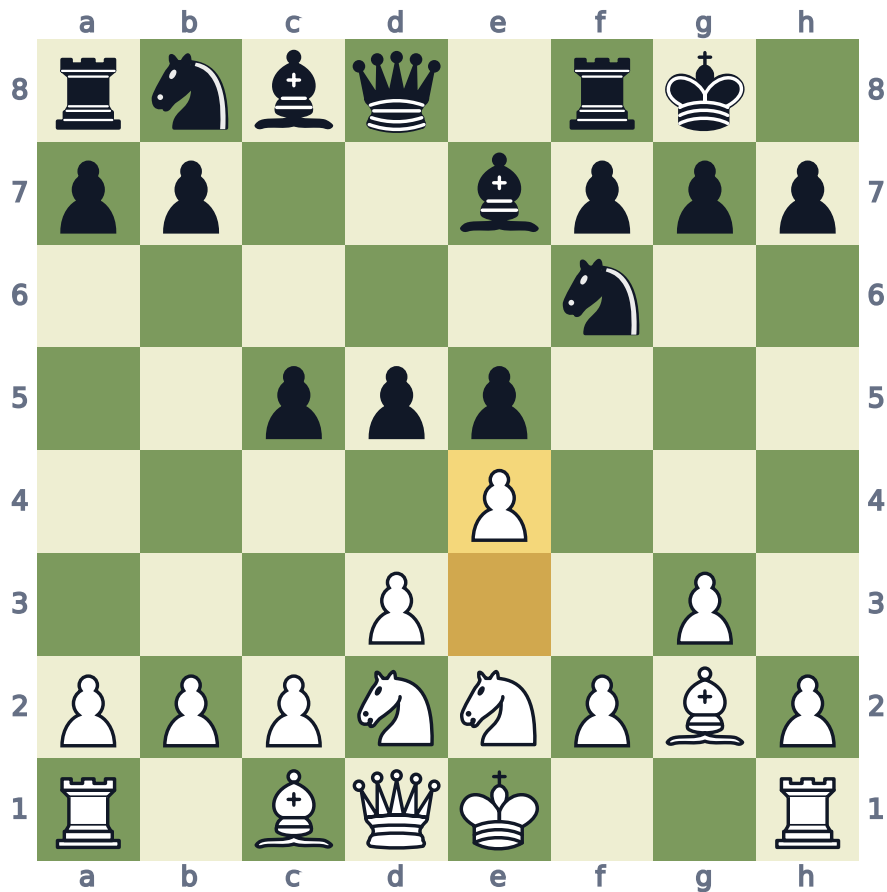
1. c5 d4 2. exd4 exd4 3. Nc6 O-O 4. Re8 c3 5. h6 Nf3
(-0.59 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

d3-first announces e4; follow through before the center closes.

STRUCTURE 22 OF 30

Prepare e4 with d3 and Nd2



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use d3, Nd2, and Ne2 to support e4 without blocking the f-pawn.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can close the center and restrict the knights.

ENGINE SAMPLE

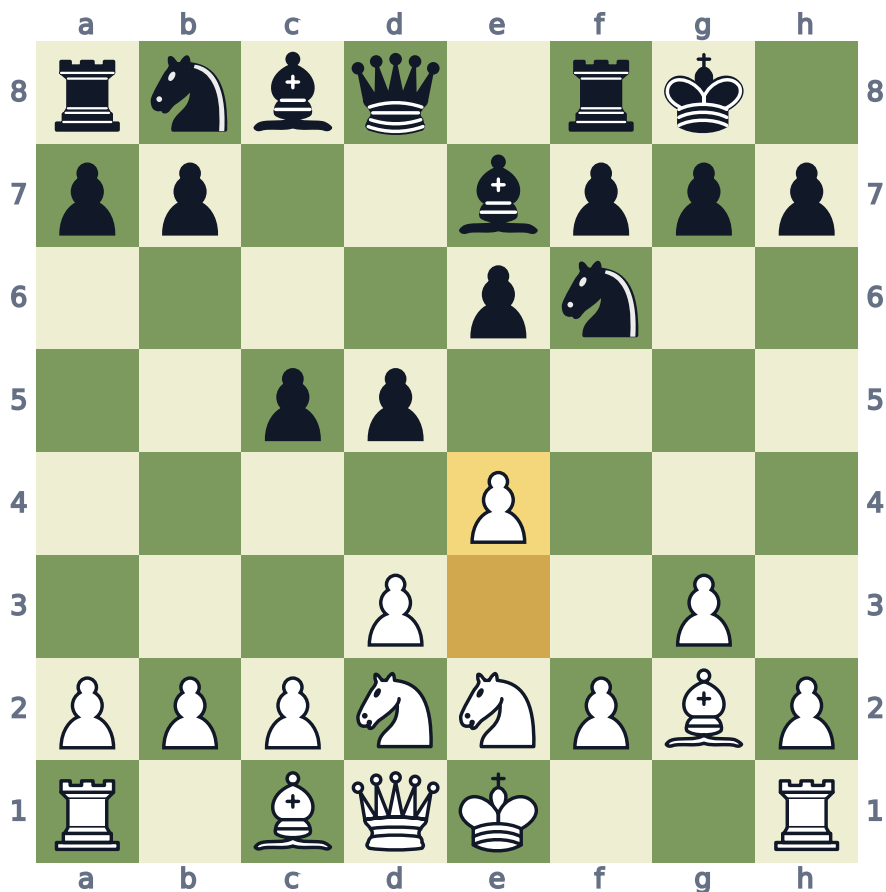
1. Nc6 O-O 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 Bb2 (-0.84 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

The e4 break is ready when the pieces can use the opened lines.

STRUCTURE 23 OF 30

e4 against a French shell



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and enter a King's Indian Attack structure.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can gain space and make c4 necessary later.

ENGINE SAMPLE

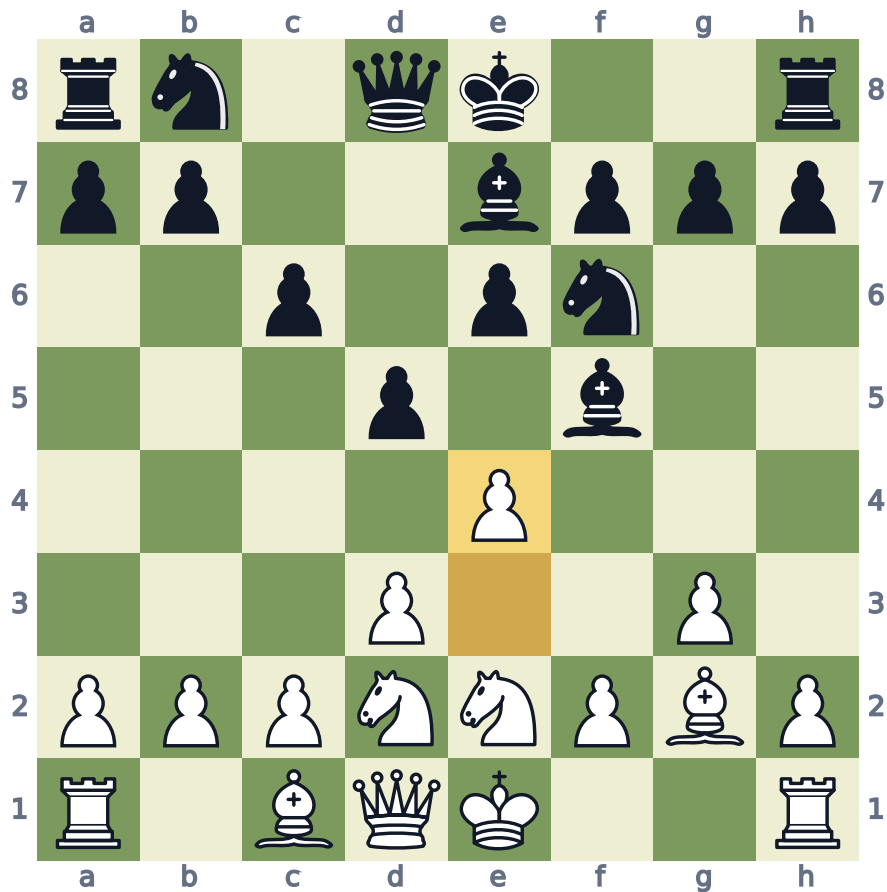
1. Nc6 exd5 2. exd5 O-O 3. Re8 Nf4 4. Bf8 Nf3 5. h6 h3
(-0.52 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

e4 attacks the base only if a second break is available after d4.

STRUCTURE 24 OF 30

e4 against a Caro shell



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Open central contact after Black's bishop leaves c8.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

dxe4 can expose an uncastled king.

ENGINE SAMPLE

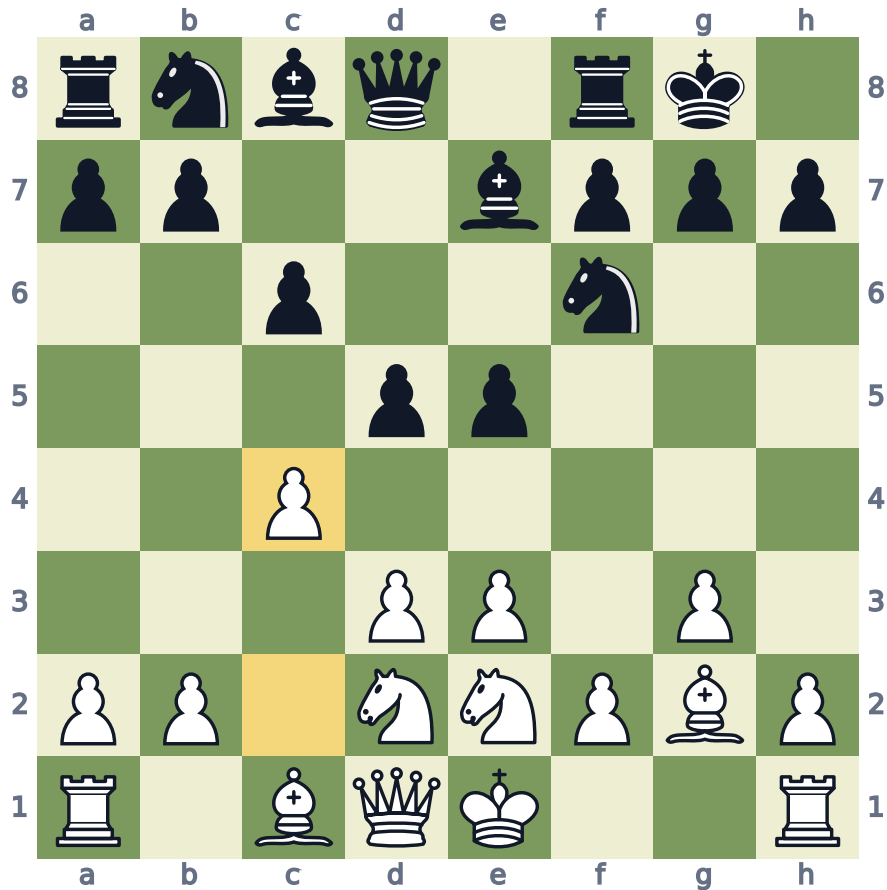
1. Bg6 Nf4 2. e5 Nxg6 3. hxg6 Qe2 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Prepare the recapture and development before e4.

STRUCTURE 25 OF 30

c4 attacks d5



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and prepare queenside play through the c-file.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can gain space and target c4.

ENGINE SAMPLE

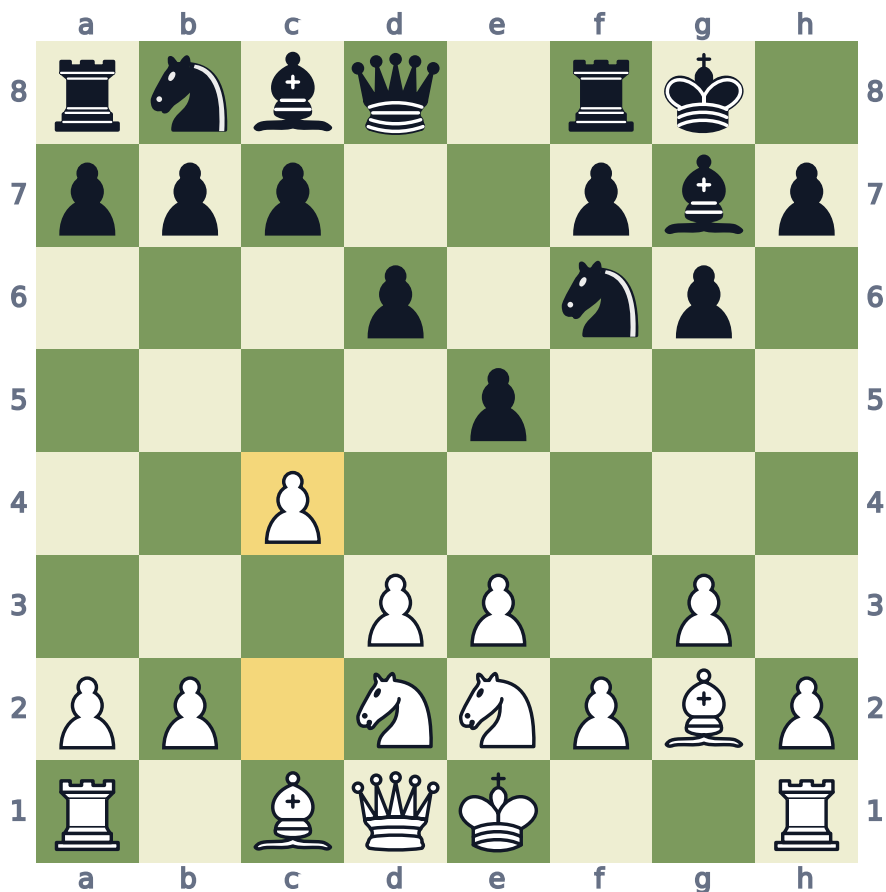
1. Bf5 e4 2. dxe4 dxe4 3. Be6 O-O 4. Na6 a3 5. Nc5 Qc2
(-1.05 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

c4 is a central lever played from the wing.

STRUCTURE 26 OF 30

c4 against mirrored fianchetto



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Control d5 and create an English-style bind.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

c6 and d5 can equalize if White is slow.

ENGINE SAMPLE

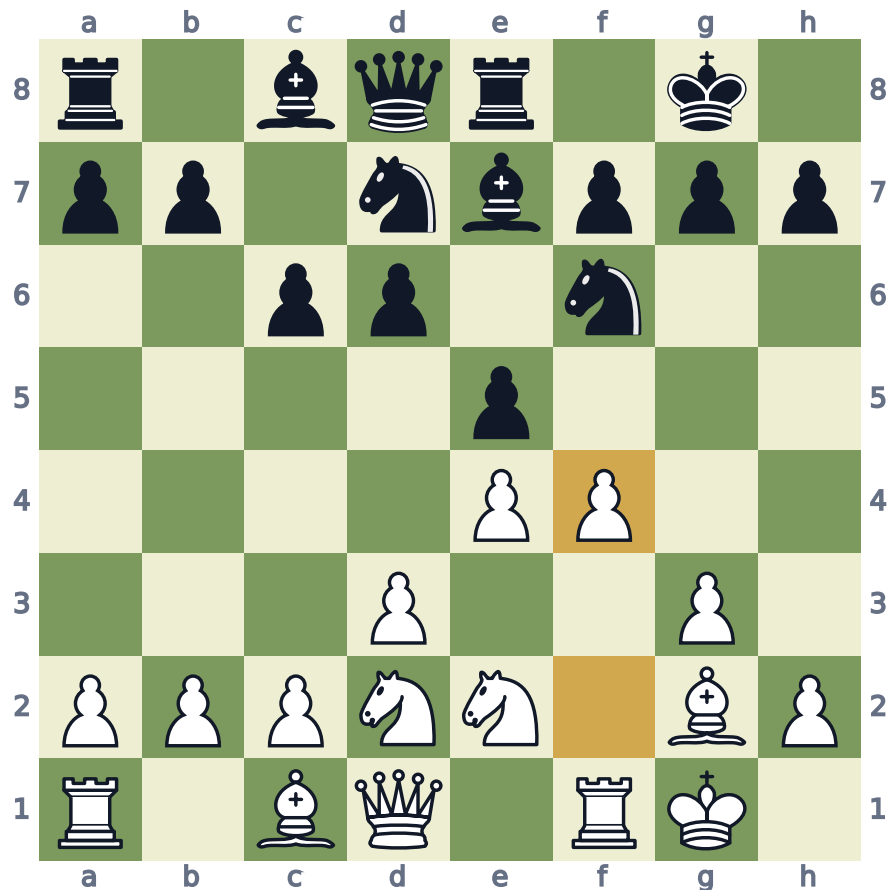
1. a5 b3 2. c6 O-O 3. Na6 Ba3 4. Nb4 Ne4 5. Nxe4 dxe4 (-0.31 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Use c4 when d5 is the most valuable square.

STRUCTURE 27 OF 30

f4 against e5



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Build the e4-f4 chain against Black's compact center after castling.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

exf4 opens lines and may expose White's king.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. d5 Nc3 2. dxe4 Ndx4 3. exf4 Bxf4 4. Nxe4 Nxe4 5. Nf6 Kh1 (-0.56 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Prepare f4 with e4 and act before Black establishes d5.

STRUCTURE 28 OF 30

Nd2 to f3



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Reroute the d2 knight to f3 when e5 and d4 need more control.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

e4 can attack the knight and gain space.

ENGINE SAMPLE

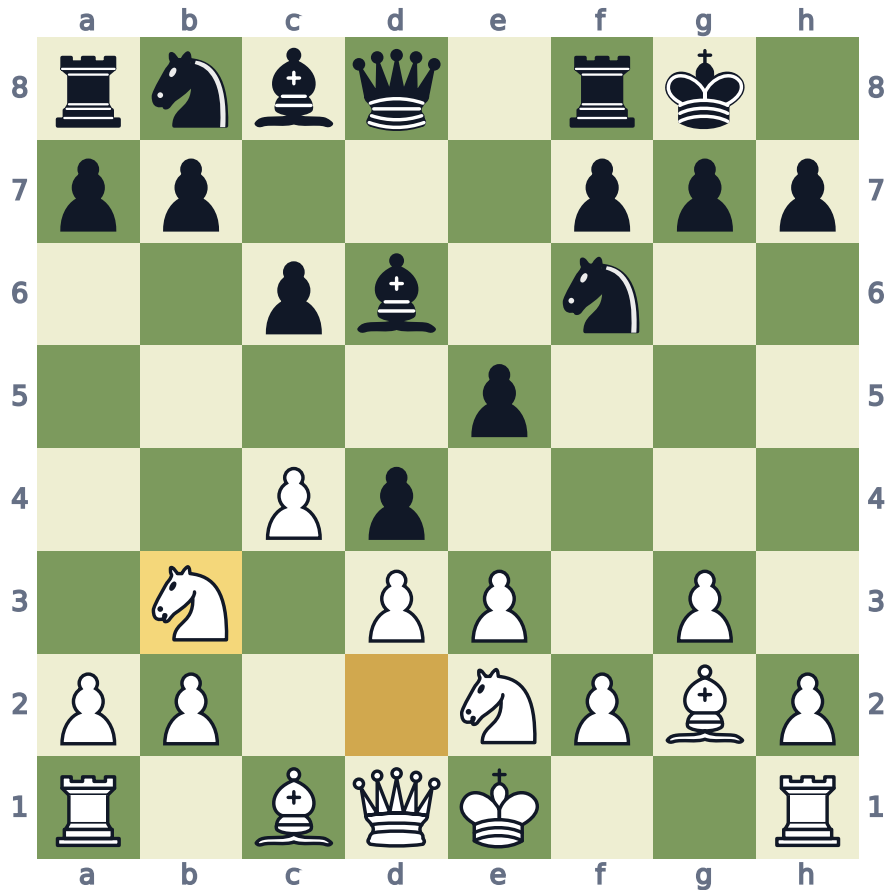
1. Qc7 b3 2. Nc6 O-O 3. h6 c4 4. Rd8 Nc3 5. d4 exd4
(-0.93 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Choose the knight route from its destination, not the setup diagram.

STRUCTURE 29 OF 30

Nd2 to c4



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use b3 as a route toward c5 and d4 after the center closes.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

b5 can chase the knight and gain queenside space.

ENGINE SAMPLE

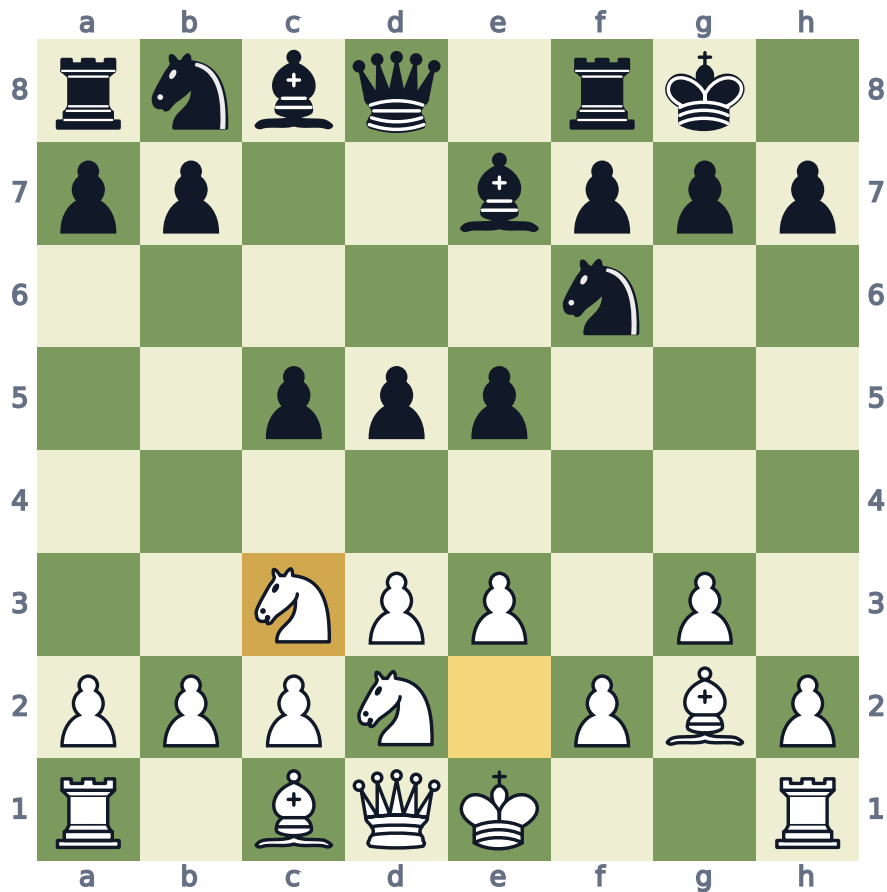
1. a5 exd4 2. a4 Nd2 3. exd4 O-O 4. Re8 Nf3 5. c5 Bg5 (-0.77 for White (Black is slightly better))

TRANSFER CUE

A closed center gives time for a knight route with a concrete target.

STRUCTURE 30 OF 30

Ne2 to c3



COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Develop toward d5 and e4 when the f-pawn is no longer the main plan.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCE

d4 can chase the knight or restrict it.

ENGINE SAMPLE

1. Nc6 O-O 2. Bg4 f3 3. Be6 e4 4. Qd7 f4 5. exf4 gxf4
(-0.95 for White (Black is clearly better))

TRANSFER CUE

Ne2-c3 is useful when f4 is less important than central control.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.